PRE-DEPARTURE CHECKLIST

71-item pre-departure checklist — 42 critical

2009 LC76 SW · 1HZ 4.2L Diesel · low-boost turbo (0.6 bar) · intercooler
Last updated: 12 October 2026

INSPECTION ZONES & CHECKLIST

Use the zones as the morning walk-around. Same order every time — engine bay, front, driver side, rear, passenger side, roof, cab — so nothing is skipped. Do it in good light with the engine cold: fluid levels, fresh leaks, anything working loose, any damage. A leak shows as a dark stain in dust and hides in mud, so look harder after a wet day. Tyre pressures and coolant are checked cold, which the morning suits (Sheppard 2008, §5.5, 'Nightly inspection' — he does his at the end of the day; the principle is the same).

A ENGINE BAY

12 items

- [ ] **Engine oil level** CRITICAL
  Check dipstick — between min and max. Top up Shell Rimula R4 X 15W-40 if needed. Note any drop since last check.
- [ ] **Coolant level** CRITICAL
  Check overflow tank — should be between MIN and MAX cold. Top up Toyota LLC 50/50 if needed. Check for sweet smell or residue around cap.
- [ ] **Brake & clutch fluid** CRITICAL
  Check reservoir — should be at MAX. Any drop indicates a leak. DOT 4 only.
- [ ] **Power steering fluid**
  Check reservoir with engine off — should be at FULL cold mark. ATF Dexron II.
- [ ] **Washer bottle**
  Top up. Not critical but useful on dusty tracks.
- [ ] **V-belts** CRITICAL
  Check tension and condition — no cracking, glazing or fraying. Press mid-span — should deflect 8–10mm.
- [ ] **Coolant hoses** CRITICAL
  Squeeze both hoses — firm but pliable. Check clamps are tight. No seeping or staining.
- [ ] **Fuel lines** CRITICAL
  Check for diesel smell or seeping around injection pump, filter, and injector return lines.
- [ ] **Air filter**
  Check pre-cleaner on snorkel — clear of debris. Check filter condition if recently in dusty conditions.
- [ ] **Oil leaks** CRITICAL
  Check underneath for fresh oil — sump, gearbox, transfer case, and the bellhousing drain hole (rear main seal or gearbox input seal — R20 §1.15). Grease thrown out of a propshaft UJ is worth a look too. Any fresh drips must be investigated.
- [ ] **Battery terminals**
  Clean, tight, no corrosion. Check both main and aux battery connections.
- [ ] **ARB compressor**
  Check mounting and air line connections are secure.

B FRONT OF VEHICLE

5 items

- [ ] **Front tyre pressures** CRITICAL
  Check both front tyres — on-road, loaded: 2.6 bar (38 psi) — LT tyre, do not use the Toyota placard. Adjust for terrain; see R14 for the full baseline table. Check for cuts, bulges or embedded objects.
- [ ] **Front tyre condition** CRITICAL
  Inspect tread and sidewalls visually. Check for slow puncture — compare height to rear tyres.
- [ ] **Winch & bull bar**
  Check winch hook is secured and line is neatly spooled. ARB bumper bolts tight. Shackles on bull bar if fitted.
- [ ] **Front lights**
  Check headlights, park lights, indicators and IPF spotlights — all operational.
- [ ] **Skid plate**
  Check mid skid plate is secure — no loose bolts or damage from previous trip.

C DRIVER SIDE

5 items

- [ ] **Driver door & mirror**
  Door hinges and seals intact. Mirror adjusted and secure.
- [ ] **Driver side tyres**
  Re-confirm front tyre checked. Visual on rear driver tyre.

- [ ] **Rear leaf springs driver side** CRITICAL
  Check U-bolts — grab and try to rotate. Check spring leaves for cracks.
- [ ] **Fuel tank** CRITICAL
  Check extended 145L tank — no seeping around fittings or tank guard. Fuel level noted.
- [ ] **Side step & body**
  Check side step secure. No loose body panels or damage that could foul tyres.

D REAR OF VEHICLE

10 items

- [ ] **Spare tyre** CRITICAL
  Check spare tyre pressure — inflated to the loaded on-road pressure (see R14 baseline table). Check it is properly mounted and locking nut is in the cab.
- [ ] **MaxTrax** CRITICAL
  Both MaxTrax boards present and mounted securely on rear door or carrier.
- [ ] **Recovery kit** CRITICAL
  Snatch rope, tow rope, shackles (metal + soft), tree protector, pulley block, line dampener, spade, PPE — all present.
- [ ] **ARB hydraulic jack + bottle jack** CRITICAL
  Both present and functional, no hydraulic leaks; jacking base board stowed. No hi-lift carried — deliberate doctrine (winch + MaxTrax, R9).
- [ ] **Bottle jack + hydraulic jack**
  Both present and accessible.
- [ ] **Load security** CRITICAL
  Check all cargo is secured — nothing loose that can shift under braking or on rough terrain. Heavy items low and forward.
- [ ] **Roof rack load** CRITICAL
  All roof rack items strapped — table, accessories. Nothing can work loose at speed.
- [ ] **Rear lights**
  Check brake lights, reverse lights, indicators and number plate light — all operational.
- [ ] **Tow bar**
  H/D gooseneck tow bar — check locking pin if not towing. Check hitch ball nut if towing.
- [ ] **Jerricans / fuel canisters**
  2× Desert Fox 20L — filled if needed. Caps tight. Stowed securely.

E PASSENGER SIDE

4 items

- [ ] **Passenger side tyres**
  Visual check front and rear — tread, sidewalls, pressure confirmed.
- [ ] **Rear leaf springs passenger side** CRITICAL
  Check U-bolts and spring condition — same as driver side.
- [ ] **Snorkel** CRITICAL
  Check snorkel intake is clear of debris, mud, bird nests. Pre-cleaner clear.
- [ ] **Passenger door & mirror**
  Door and seal intact. Mirror adjusted.

F ROOF RACK

3 items

- [ ] **Roof rack structure** CRITICAL
  Check all rack mounting bolts — grab and try to move the rack. No movement.
- [ ] **Aluminium table**
  Table is folded and secured to rack underside. Nothing loose.
- [ ] **Solar panels (if deployed)**
  Hardkorr 200W portable panels — stowed and strapped. Cables not trailing.

G CAB INTERIOR

12 items

- [ ] **GPS / maps** CRITICAL
  GPS powered and updated. Paper maps for the route in the cab. Offline maps downloaded.
- [ ] **Vehicle documents** CRITICAL
  Registration (RC1) original + certified copy, insurance, roadworthy, permits — all present and in date. If Neil drives without Mary-Ann at any point: commissioned owner's-authority affidavit aboard (R39 §3 supplement — vehicle registered to Mary-Ann).
- [ ] **Passports & visas** CRITICAL
  All passports present. Visas checked for validity and correct country.

- [ ] **Emergency contacts list** CRITICAL
  Printed list of emergency contacts, nearest hospital, recovery contacts for the route.
- [ ] **Communication device** CRITICAL
  Satellite communicator / PLB — charged and registered. Test check-in sent.
- [ ] **First aid kit** CRITICAL
  Kit is present, stocked and accessible. Check expiry on critical medications.
- [ ] **Personal medications** CRITICAL
  All personal medications packed — sufficient supply for trip duration plus 3 days.
- [ ] **Drinking water** CRITICAL
  Minimum 4L per person per day. Check containers sealed and accessible.
- [ ] **Food supply**
  Provisioned for trip duration plus 2 days emergency reserve.
- [ ] **National Luna fridge 55L**
  Powered on, set to correct temperature, loaded and sealed. Check contents.
- [ ] **Spare tyre locking key** CRITICAL
  In glovebox or cab — not in cargo that could become inaccessible.
- [ ] **Spares box accessible**
  Know where the spares box is. Critical items (oil, coolant, V-belts) accessible without unpacking everything.

H PRE-START & ELECTRICAL

11 items

- [ ] **Aux battery voltage** CRITICAL
  Check BMV-712 — house battery SOC 90%+ and 13.2V+ rested (LiFePO4). If SOC is below ~70% or voltage below 13.0V rested, charge or investigate before departure.
- [ ] **BatteryProtect & battery switch**
  Check the M-series battery switch is ON and the Smart BatteryProtect shows normal (connected) state — no fault code in VictronConnect. House battery charges via the DC-DC once the engine starts.
- [ ] **MultiPlus inverter/charger**
  Set correctly — inverter off (or charger-only) for driving. Not drawing idle load unnecessarily.
- [ ] **TPMS system**
  Steel Mate Solar TPMS — all 4 sensors reading. Note baseline pressures.
- [ ] **All electrics off**
  Check lights, fridge draw, inverter load — nothing unnecessary draining battery before start.
- [ ] **Glow plug preheat** CRITICAL
  Allow full preheat cycle before cranking — especially cold mornings. Wait for glow light to extinguish.
- [ ] **Engine start & idle** CRITICAL
  Start engine. Allow to idle 2–3 minutes. Check for warning lights, unusual smoke or noises.
- [ ] **Oil pressure warning** CRITICAL
  Oil pressure light should extinguish within 3 seconds of start. If it stays on — stop immediately.
- [ ] **Alternator output**
  Check voltmeter — should read 13.8–14.4V at idle. Confirms alternator charging.
- [ ] **EGT & boost gauges** CRITICAL
  EGT reads ambient-sane cold and responds on rev; boost gauge live (0.6 bar reference at load). These are the turbo 1HZ's primary protection instruments — a dead gauge is a no-go. Thresholds per R21.
- [ ] **Brake pedal** CRITICAL
  Press brake pedal firmly — should be firm, not spongy or sinking. Check handbrake holds.

I FINAL PRE-DEPARTURE

9 items

- [ ] **Walk-around complete** CRITICAL
  Confirm all zones A–H checked. Nothing left on roof, bonnet or behind tyres.
- [ ] **Doors & windows**
  All doors closed and latched. Windows up or set as preferred. Roof hatch closed.
- [ ] **Route confirmed** CRITICAL
  Route for the day confirmed. First fuel stop identified. Camp location known.
- [ ] **Departure time noted**
  Note departure time for ETA calculations and emergency reference.

- [ ] **Hub locks**
  If entering 4WD terrain — hubs locked before departure, not on the track.

- [ ] **Phone charged**
  Driver phone at 100% — emergency contact and backup navigation.

- [ ] **Check in** CRITICAL
  Check in with an off-route contact — confirm route, expected check-in times, emergency protocol.

- [ ] **InReach live test** CRITICAL
  Test message sent and confirmed received by the anchor; subscription and charge verified. Device rides on the person, not packed. Protocol: R16 §6 · sign-off: R38 §1 (RA-10).

- [ ] **Fire kit** CRITICAL
  Extinguisher gauges in the green, powder inverted-and-tapped (corrugations cake dry powder), mounts tight; fire blanket in its quick-release pouch; aerosol suppressor sticks in the door pocket and tent bag; tent knives accessible. Doctrine & sizing: R42 §1.